

Social Media

Has social media changed the nature of friendship for better or worse?



Should children under 16 be banned from using social media?



If social media disappeared tomorrow, would society
be better or worse off?



Discussion Questions



1. Should employers and universities consider applicants' social media activity when making decisions?
2. Influencers can affect what people buy, believe, and support. Is this a positive development? Why or why not?
3. Should people be allowed to remain anonymous on social media?
4. Are social media companies doing enough to protect their users?
5. Overall, do the benefits of social media outweigh the risks?

Gender

Do traditional gender roles still influence people's
life choices?



Has enough progress been made towards gender equality in the workplace?



Some people argue that gender equality benefits everyone, not just women. Do you agree?



Task 3 – Discussion Questions



1. Should schools do more to challenge gender stereotypes? If so, how?
2. Several countries have introduced paid parental leave for both parents. What are the advantages and disadvantages of this policy?
3. Which do you think has the greater impact on opportunities today: gender, social class, or ethnicity? Explain your answer.
4. Should employers be required to publish information about gender pay differences within their organisations?
5. How much of a person's understanding of gender comes from family, education, and the media?

Demographics

Global life expectancy has increased significantly over the last century. Is this creating new challenges for society?



South Korea has one of the lowest birth rates in the world. What impact could this have on the country's future?



Many African countries have rapidly growing populations. What opportunities and challenges might this create?



Population – Discussion Questions



1. Do you think governments should encourage people to have more children, fewer children, or neither? Why?
2. Many developed countries rely on immigration to address labour shortages. Is this a good long-term solution?
3. Some cities are experiencing population decline while others are growing rapidly. Which presents the greater challenge?
4. As people live longer, should the retirement age continue to increase? Why or why not?
5. Would you rather live in a country with a very diverse population or a relatively homogeneous one? Explain your answer

Climate Change

Does describing climate change as a "crisis" help motivate action, or does it create fear and anxiety?



Which is more persuasive: talking about the risks of climate change or the benefits of climate action?



Should climate policies be framed around national interests or international cooperation?



Population – Discussion Questions



1. People have been hearing about climate change for decades. Do you think some audiences have become less responsive to the message?
2. Do younger and older generations respond differently to climate change messages? Why might this be the case?
3. Do you think climate change should be framed as an environmental issue, an economic issue, or a social justice issue? Why?
4. Which is more persuasive: stories about individual experiences or scientific statistics?
5. Should climate campaigners use emotional appeals such as fear, hope, or guilt?